them with an overload of organic material. Detergents replaced soaps on the markets, argued Commoner, not because they were better at cleaning but because of the advertising efforts of detergent manufacturers.

He provides a *third example* which deals with *textile production*. Synthetic fibres, which are often derived from non-renewable resources such as oil or natural gas, have replaced natural fibres such as cotton and wool in many applications. They require extremely high temperatures to manufacture, which adds to air pollution and energy usage. Furthermore, unlike the natural fibres, they do not break down in the environment. The manufacture of synthetic fibres, plastics and detergents has required big increases in the production of organic chemicals. Since mercury was used to manufacture organic chemicals, this meant the load of mercury in the environment increased.

He concluded that the new technologies also used more electric power and other forms of energy than those they replaced. During the time he was writing the book, aluminium and chemical production alone accounted for 28 per cent of US industrial electricity use. This, in itself, meant more use of energy resources and more pollution.

Precisely, the experts today conclude that though technologies seemed to be solving the immediate problems of humanity's urge for higher growth and development, they were basically, adding problems for the future in a hidden way. It means, every technology had a hidden cost to it. Mankind went on excluding those costs intentionally or unintetionally – a clear case of 'flawed accounting and thinking about the risk'.[8] Those hidden costs were just waiting there to become visible. They are now taking toll in the forms of 'disturbed weather conditions', 'melting ice-shields', 'submerging islands' and finally, culminating into the greater danger of 'climate change'.

THE POSSIBLE ALTERNATIVE

The idea of an 'appropriate technology', which could provide sustainability to our planet and at the same time does not hinder the growth of humanity either, has always been a hot topic of debate, epecially, in the western world. The first idea of 'Appropriate Technology' was formulated by the